TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Compare Two Suppliers and Recommend One

Recommend | OREO | Make a Recommendation

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Compare two options against what the company needs, recommend one with reasons, and respond to a concern about your choice.

WHO Your company is running a customer event in two weeks and needs 200 printed T-shirts.

SITUATION You have two quotes. Ace Print: RM18 each, delivery in 5 days, you used them last year and the quality was good. Budget Tees: RM12 each, delivery in 12 days, cheaper, but you have not seen their samples yet.

NEED Mr. Tan wants your recommendation this afternoon. The budget is about RM3,000, and the shirts must arrive on time.

GOAL Recommend one supplier, explain why it fits the needs (time, quality, cost), and respond to Mr. Tan's concern.

Ace Print

- RM18 per shirt · RM3,600 total (over budget)
- Delivery: 5 days
- Used last year — good quality

Budget Tees

- RM12 per shirt · RM2,400 total
- Delivery: 12 days
- New supplier — no samples yet

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "So, which supplier should we go with? We need those shirts in two weeks." Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Kumar's answer. Mark where each part starts.

We need the shirts on time for the event, so I'd recommend Ace Print. The main reason is delivery, because the event is in two weeks. Ace Print needs five days, but Budget Tees needs twelve. I know Ace Print costs RM3,600, which is RM600 over budget, but we used them last year and the quality was good. Budget Tees is cheaper, but we haven't seen samples. So overall, if the shirts must arrive on time, Ace Print is the safer choice.

O RECOMMENDATION

R REASON

E COMPARE · EXAMPLE

O RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali recommends a laptop for new staff. Order: Recommendation → Reason → Compare → Recommendation again.

- [ ] That's why the Lenovo is the better choice for us.
- [ ] The main reason is that it has a longer battery life, which matters because the sales team travels a lot.
- [ ] I think we should go with the Lenovo.
- [ ] The Acer is about RM300 cheaper, but its battery only lasts four hours. Kumar's old Acer died in every long meeting.

Write the letter: **O** = Recommendation · **R** = Reason · **E** = Compare · example · **O** = Recommendation again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

NAME THE NEEDS

- [ ] The most important thing is …
- [ ] We need it by …
- [ ] Our budget is …

COMPARE

- [ ] A is cheaper than B.
- [ ] B takes longer than A.
- [ ] Both are …, but …
- [ ] A has better …

RECOMMEND

- [ ] I'd recommend …
- [ ] I think we should go with …
- [ ] It may be better to …
- [ ] … is the safer choice.

JUSTIFY

- [ ] The main reason is …
- [ ] The advantage is …
- [ ] One risk is …
- [ ] We used them before and …

RESPOND TO A CONCERN

- [ ] I understand the cost is higher, but …
- [ ] That's true, but … / However, …
- [ ] If budget is the problem, we could …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Budget Tees is cheaper. [so / but / for example,] They need twelve days.

_____

2. Ace Print can deliver in five days. [but / so / however] We'll have time to check the shirts.

_____

3. We used Ace Print last year. [so / if / but] We know the quality is good.

_____

4. Budget is the problem. [For example, / because / If …] We could order fewer shirts from Ace Print.

_____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Budget Tees _____ twelve days to deliver. (A fact about the options now)
   - ○ needing
   - ○ needs
   - ○ to need
2. Last year we _____ Ace Print and the quality was good. (Past experience)
   - ○ used
   - ○ use
   - ○ are using
3. If we choose Ace Print, the shirts _____ here in five days. (What will happen if we choose one)
   - ○ were
   - ○ are being
   - ○ will be
4. Ace Print is _____ than Budget Tees. (Comparing)
   - ○ more expensive
   - ○ most expensive
   - ○ expensive

SLIDE 09 Comparing · should / could · if

A recommendation compares options, says what we should do, and can add a condition.

Budget Tees is **cheaper than** Ace Print, but Ace Print is **faster**.

Ace Print is **the safer** choice.

I think we **should** go with Ace Print. We **could** order fewer shirts.

If we choose Budget Tees, we **won't** have time to fix mistakes.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O RECOMMENDATION

I'd recommend …

R REASON

The main reason is …

E COMPARE · EXAMPLE

… is cheaper / faster than …, but …

O RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

So overall, …

SLIDE 11

Make a Recommendation

The recommender finds out the manager's need, recommends one of two options and answers one concern. The manager writes a decision note: the choice and the main reason.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number, ask what the manager needs (they read that card's listener side). Recommend.
2. Manager: fill in the listener's note, then raise one concern. Recommender: acknowledge it and answer in 1–2 sentences.
3. Round 2 (2:00): managers move one seat. Same card to a new manager, shorter: the need, one reason, one comparison.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: recommenders turn the workbook over, new manager. Then swap roles: rounds 1–3 again.

Card 1 · Caterer for the annual dinner

Card 2 · Courier for daily deliveries

Card 3 · Coffee machine for the office

Manager's decision note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card no.			
Choice			
Main reason			
Concern: answered?			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. What if the budget doesn't allow it?
2. Can we get the cheaper one faster?
3. Have you actually checked their quality?

Start with: **I understand the cost is higher, but … · Good question. I can ask them and tell you by … · I see. In that case, I'd go with … instead.**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend asks which of two gyms to join: one is near home and cheap but small; the other is bigger with classes but far away. Recommend one and explain why.

I'd recommend … · The main reason is … · … is cheaper, but … · So overall, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Names the need and recommends one option.
- [ ] Gives a reason and compares both options on it.
- [ ] Acknowledges one concern and answers it.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need and recommendation	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason and comparison	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Caterer for the annual dinner

You are Mr. Tan. Your needs: the annual dinner is for 60 people, the budget is about RM1,800, and the food must be good. Write the choice and the reason. Ask one concern.

Card 2 · Courier for daily deliveries

You are Mr. Tan. Your need: customers often call to ask 'Where is my parcel?', and answering them takes staff time. Write the choice and the reason. Ask one concern.

Card 3 · Coffee machine for the office

You are Mr. Tan. Your needs: the office has 12 staff who drink a lot of coffee, and the budget is tight this year. Write the choice and the reason. Ask one concern.

SLIDE 11 Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Caterer for the annual dinner

Both are halal. Rasa Catering: RM35 a head, 10 dishes, did our open house last year and the food was good. Happy Wok: RM28 a head, 7 dishes, new to us, free tasting on Friday.

Card 2 · Courier for daily deliveries

Fast Go: RM8 per parcel, same-day, tracking app. City Post: RM5 per parcel, next-day, no tracking.

Card 3 · Coffee machine for the office

Rent: RM150 a month, free repairs, can cancel any time. Buy: RM2,800 once, one-year warranty, then repairs are extra.